

Which of the following symptoms is LEAST characteristic of a dissociative disorder?

- ☐ A. Recurrent gaps in memory and more than one distinct personality [3%]
- ☐ B. Inability to remember details of a traumatic experience [10%]
- ✓ ☒ C. Fabricated memory loss in order to gain sympathy from others [75%]
- ☐ D. Difficulty remembering important autobiographical information [9%]

Correct

74% answered correctly

Explanation:

Dissociative disorders	
Dissociative identity disorder	• Presence of two or more distinct personalities; amnesia
Dissociative amnesia	• Inability to recall important autobiographical information

Dissociative disorders are characterized by **disruptions** to **memory** and **identity**. Two specific types of dissociative disorders, **dissociative amnesia** and **dissociative identity disorder** (DID), both feature the **inability** to **recall** important **autobiographical information**. This amnesia may be generalized for identity-related information and history (eg, name, marital status) or localized for specific events (eg, a traumatic experience).

Factitious disorder is a somatic symptom and related disorder (SSRD) that involves falsifying physical or psychological symptoms without obvious external gain (eg, disability benefits). Fabricated memory loss to gain sympathy from others is characteristic of factitious disorder (an SSRD); therefore, this symptom is *least* characteristic of a dissociative disorder.

(Choice A) In addition to gaps in memory, DID is characterized by the presence of two or more distinct personalities. Individuals with DID experience a discontinuous sense of self.

(Choices B and D) The amnesia characteristic of dissociative amnesia and DID may involve an inability to remember the details of a traumatic experience or difficulty remembering important autobiographical information.

Educational objective:

Dissociative disorders are characterized by disruptions to memory and identity. Dissociative amnesia involves the inability to recall important autobiographical information (eg, personal history, traumatic event). Dissociative identity disorder is characterized by the presence of two or more distinct personalities and amnesia.

Time spent:0 sec

Subject:

Behavioral Sciences

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System:

Motivation, Emotion, Attitudes, Personality, and Stress